Agile Team Charter

1. Team Purpose & Vision

Why do we exist as a team?

We exist to develop a digital solution that improves daily commuting by reducing traffic congestion and making transportation more efficient for people in Cape Town. Using carpooling as a solution to this problem.

Team Mission

What problem are we solving?

Our mission is to solve the problem of traffic congestion and inefficient commuting experienced by students and workers in Cape Town, particularly those travelling to institutions like CPUT and nearby business districts.

We aim to help commuters who:

- Travel long distances daily
- Experience heavy traffic during peak hours
- Spend extra time and money on transport

By providing a carpooling platform, we enable people travelling to similar destinations to share rides.

Success Definition

We will consider our project successful if:

- Users can sign up, log in, and use the app easily
- Drivers can create carpools and passengers can join rides successfully
- The system prevents issues like overbooking seats
- Users can view and book rides without errors
- The app demonstrates a working MVP (Minimum Viable Product) with core features implemented
- There is clear evidence that the solution can reduce the number of single occupancy vehicles

Product / Service:

We are responsible for delivering a carpooling mobile application and website that connects drivers and passengers.

The product will include:

- User registration and login system
- Ability for drivers to post available trips
- Ability for passengers to search and join carpools
- Display of trip details (location, time, available seats)
- A simple, user-friendly interface

This platform will provide a safe, affordable, and efficient way to share transport and reduce traffic congestion.

2. Team Members and Roles

Name	Role	Key Responsibilities
Micheala Martin	Group Leader, Backend Developer	Developing the app's backend logic (including user management and carpooling) - providing design, development, management of database, as well as ensuring seamless data flow between the backend (the database) and frontend (UI).
Raees Jaffar	Backend Developer	Assist with backend programming such as setting up databases, validating data, and creating system logic.
Ndumiso Hlatshwayo	Wireframes Designer	Creates wireframes for the key screens to layout the app design. Will make sure the usability of the app is clear and well-structured so that users can find and use it easily.
As’ad Gaidien	Wireframes Designer	Assist in the creation of wireframes to enhance usability and user experience within an application by using wireframes as a method of creating visually appealing layouts that allow for easy navigation throughout the application.
Kyle Louw	Frontend Developer	Develops the user interface from wireframes to include the screens, forms, and navigation of the application ensuring the application is visually clear and responsive.
Robin Kaylor	Frontend Developer	Facilities communication between front and backend and tracking interactions with users. Facilitates seamless interaction; allows accurate display of data within an application.

3. Ways of Working

How we work together day to day

3.1 Agile Framework

- ☐ Kanban

3.2 Ceremonies

Ceremony	Frequency	Purpose
Daily Stand-up	5 days a week	To gather information from the team to help better understand the process of the project
Planning	At the start of the week or new assignment	To help better prepare for what needs to be done
Review / Demo	At the end of the week or when an assignment is completed	To help improve certain areas of the work that needs to be done
Retrospective	Every 2 weeks	To get a broader understanding on everything we've done and to figure out where we can improve for the future

4. Work Agreements

- We stay in contact through messages and during meetings, especially when something is unclear or if problems come up.
- We meet five times a week for about 30 minutes to check progress, talk about challenges, and plan what's next.
- We aim to finish our work on time (or a bit earlier if possible) so we have space to review and improve it before submitting.
- Tasks are shared out based on people's strengths or what they're comfortable doing.
- If disagreements or issues come up, we talk them through properly as a team in a respectful and fair way.
- Our meetings are at 8pm, and if someone can't make it, we make sure they're filled in so they don't miss out.

- Everyone puts in their best effort so the work we produce is something we can all be proud of.

5. Communication Plan

Our team communicates mainly through Microsoft Teams. One team member is responsible for creating the meeting links and sending them to the rest of the group before each meeting.

We meet every day at 8 PM for about 30 minutes. These meetings are used to discuss our progress, what each member has completed, and what we are planning to do next. It also gives us a chance to talk about any challenges or issues we are experiencing with our tasks. Our meetings are hybrid, as we all join from our own homes using Microsoft Teams. Cameras are not required, as we mainly communicate using voice and chat.

If there is an urgent problem, any team member can send a message in the group chat to request an extra meeting. This allows us to quickly come together and solve the issue without delaying the project.

We also use a task board to manage our work. The task board helps us track what tasks still need to be done, what is currently in progress, and what has already been completed. This keeps everyone organized and aware of the team's overall progress.

There are also some basic rules we follow to keep communication effective. All team members are expected to attend meetings, be punctual, and actively participate in discussions. This helps ensure that everyone stays informed and contributes to the success of the project.

6. Decision-Making Process

In our team, decisions are made together to ensure that everyone has a voice. Each member is given the opportunity to share their ideas and opinions during discussions.

After everyone has contributed, we usually make decisions by voting. The option with the most votes is chosen, as this is the fairest and simplest way to decide as a group.

If there are disagreements, we handle them by considering each member's strengths and roles in the project. For example, if the decision is related to design, the team member responsible for front-end work will have more input. This helps us make better decisions based on knowledge and experience.

Although everyone in the team is equal and has a say, the team leader has slightly more authority. This is because the team leader was chosen to guide the team and help keep everything on track.

7. Definition of Done (DoD)

The work is considered done when:

- Code is completed & reviewed by at least 1 team member
- Feature works as intended (ride matching, booking, route display)
- All tests pass (unit & basic user testing)
- No critical bugs
- UI/UX is consistent & user-friendly
- Integrated with backend (user login, ride database, location services)
- Documentation is updated
- Product Owner approves the feature
- Deployed to a test or demo environment
- Performance tested for peak usage
- Basic security checks completed
- Works on mobile screen sizes

8. Core Values and Behaviors

Trust

- Be open about how your work is going, even if you’re struggling
- Do what you said you would do and follow through

Respect

- Listen to everyone’s ideas and give them a fair chance
- Give feedback in a positive way that helps improve things, not shut people down

Accountability

- Get your work done on time based on what the team agreed
- Own up to mistakes and fix them instead of ignoring them

Open and Honest Communication

- Keep everyone in the loop with your progress
- Ask when you don’t understand something instead of guessing
- Be open to feedback and actually use it

Adaptability

- Be okay with changes and adjust when things don’t go as planned
- Be willing to try different approaches if needed

Time Commitment

- Show up to meetings on time, or let the team know if you can’t make it
- Stay on top of your work so it doesn’t pile up later

Responsiveness

- Reply to messages within the day so things keep moving
- Let the team know if you’re busy or won’t be able to respond quickly

9. Risks & Constraints

Known Risks

- Difficulty integrating frontend, backend & database components
- Limited experience with real-time features such as ride matching
- Bugs & errors delaying development progress
- Poor team coordination leading to incomplete features
- Scope creep from adding too many features
- Inconsistent coding styles or version control conflicts

Dependencies

- Team member availability & contributions
- Development tools (IDEs, GitHub. Figma)
- Access to learning resources for new technologies
- Stable development environment & internet access
- External APIs for maps or location services

Constraints

- Limited time due to academic deadlines
- No budget for premium tools or APIs
- Reliance on free or limited tools
- Compatibility issues between tools
- Limited experience with mobile development, backend systems & debugging

Mitigation Strategy

- Focus on delivering a functional prototype with core features
- Use version control (Git) for collaboration
- Allocate time for learning & debugging

10. Team Commitment

Our agreement to this charter

By working on this team, we commit to the principles and agreements outlined above.

Name	Signature/Agreement
Raees	R.Jaffar
Micheala	M.Martin
Kyle	K.Louw
Robin	R.Kaylor
As’ad	A.Gaidien
Ndumiso	N.Hlatshwayo